sucking on water bottles and just drinking the moment in.

Without Sven saying anything, I think every England player was already starting to think about the next game in four days' time against Albania. Anybody who wasn't was hearing all about it from the likes of Gary Neville. What had just happened was unbelievable but it wouldn't mean anything if we didn't win next Wednesday at St James' Park. You live a life in soccer, as a supporter or a player, for nights like Germany 1 England 5. From game to game, though, putting the history and the glory to one side, the opposition doesn't matter. Victory always means the same thing. As Mr Eriksson says: it's another three points.

I sat in my place, leaning back against the wall. I thought back to Wembley on a wet Saturday afternoon less than a year before. And to Kevin Keegan, in the dressing room after we'd lost 1–0, telling us he'd taken England as far as he thought he could. I remembered the press and plenty of our supporters writing off the World Cup adventure before it had even begun. In my heart of hearts, I knew I'd have been hard pushed, back then, to disagree with the doom merchants. Losing to Germany was a blow. For me personally—and for England, I thought—losing Kevin had felt like the end of the world. Now, eleven months later, we were on the brink of beating our old rivals to top the group.

Who knows what might have happened if Kevin had decided to carry on? I believe in him as a manager. Just look at what he's achieved at Manchester City over the past couple of years. And I've got limitless respect for him as a man. Sometimes, though, change happens not because anybody wants it to but because it has to. I loved playing for England under Kevin. A year later, I was captaining my country under Sven-Goran Eriksson. The new manager had brought through a new generation of England players and given us the chance to develop as a team. Sven and Alex Ferguson couldn't be more different in their approach to individual players. The way they went about trying to build successful teams, though, was exactly the same. As far as the England side was concerned, the performance and the scoreline in Munich were all anyone needed to see how successful the Swedish revolution had been.